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Engineering leader · 25+ years shipping production software · Builds the system every engineer and every agent works inside, so one squad ships like several, with proof

SUMMARY

Engineering leader with 25+ years shipping production software and four director-level engineering roles across aviation, IoT, and enterprise AI. At Parslee.AI I built the system that took my merged output from 59 pull requests a month to 505, with none of my 466 changes in our two main codebases reverted, by building AI agent fleets that run under an independent reviewer, mandatory evidence gates, and a written authority model. The system is documented, public, and already adopted by engineers other than me. Most engineers improve their own output. I improve the system every engineer and every agent works inside, so the gain compounds after I leave the room. I can prove it inside one Axon squad in a quarter.

THE UNLOCK FOR AXON

- **Where the effort goes.** Strong engineers write good code. I write the definition of done before the code exists, encode every correction as a rule or a check so it never has to be made twice, and accept nothing on the author's word. That shift, from writing and reviewing code to designing the system the whole team works inside, is what moves a squad to department output, and it is teachable.
- **The result, in Axon terms.** Axon Records exists to get officers out from behind the desk. The limit on how fast that product improves is engineering throughput. The system I run took my merged pull requests from 59 to 505 a month in twelve months. Every change is verified before a customer sees it. About a third of that work was product change (Microsoft 365 integration, billing, onboarding, CRM); most of the rest built and tested the fleets' own tooling.
- **Hard problems go in a loop, not a backlog.** When a goal has a measurable score, a hit rate, a latency, a match rate, I define the experiment once and let a fleet run it: one model proposes techniques, another implements, a third tests, and anything that does not beat the last high mark is rolled back. Teams stop debating ideas and start measuring them, overnight.
- **Nothing merges on an agent's word.** A separate reviewer re-runs the evidence, a bench must pass, anything user-facing is walked in a real browser before merge and again in production, and production traffic moves only to a version the verifier has already walked. Consequential actions are sorted in writing into ask-first (9 kinds), never (1), do-then-tell (12), and just-do (8). In the 30 days to October 9, 2026, none of the 466 changes I merged into our two main codebases was reverted.
- **It transfers to the engineers you already have.** I did not build a personal workflow. I built Wheelhouse, a public, free-to-use (Unlicense) template that installs a fleet into any repository in one session, plus a seven-stage path from "one agent" to "systems that build systems," each stage with an exit test. Teammates have adopted it without me in the room, and it works the same for a distributed or offshore team. The first Axon squad becomes the template for the next ten.
- **It compounds.** Every correction goes into the fleet's standing brief, dated, in my words, or becomes a lint rule or bench check, so the same mistake stops recurring. The judgment that used to live in senior engineers' heads and in code-review comments lives in the codebase, the tests, and the shared contracts, and every engineer and every agent starts from it.
- **Done is written first.** For anything larger than a routine change, agents write the outcomes and one yes/no check per outcome before a line of code exists. On September 18, five writer agents and a critic produced 235 outcomes and 215 checks for a code-review agent; 211 were met with evidence, six pull requests shipped, and a cross-vendor verifier found two critical holes that nothing else caught.
- **The cost is a rounding error.** The fleets run on about $1,800 a month in flat-rate subscriptions; at API list pricing that month's usage, the fleets' and mine, would be roughly $33K.

WHAT I NEED FROM AXON

One squad, one quarter, and the authority to install the system. Remote, as I have led every team since 2018. Measure me on merged, verified, customer-facing change, and on whether the engineers on that squad want to keep working this way.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Parslee.AI — Director of Engineering Remote · Sep 2025 – Present

Parslee puts policy-gated AI employees inside a company's Microsoft 365, acting on email, calendar, calls, CRM, and documents: the same trust problem a records or evidence platform has.

- Grew my merged output from 59 pull requests in September 2025 to 505 in the 30 days to October 9, 2026 (3,100+ merged since September 2025) by building and rolling out agent-fleet delivery across five codebases.
- Built Wheelhouse, the public agent-fleet template (github.com/morebetterltd/wheelhouse) that turns a goal and its acceptance checks into builder, reviewer, and checker work, adopted by a couple of engineers on the team.
- Contribute to CAR, the Common Agent Runtime that checks every proposed model action against policy before it runs, the control layer that lets AI act on customer data. Built goalpool to queue and fail over agent work across accounts; Parslee has cleared it to be open-sourced.
- Lead the engineering team (three engineers, now two) and onboard engineers onto fleet-based delivery.

flyExclusive, Inc. — Director of Engineering Remote · Sep 2024 – Sep 2025

- Took the pilot mobile app from unused to installed and used regularly by every pilot, about 270 of them, by rebuilding it with a team of two engineers.

Volato, Inc. — Director of Software Engineering Remote · 2022 – Sep 2024

- Built and led a software engineering team of four engineers plus a couple of contractors across customer, crew, and internal systems.
- Delivered Fly Vaunt, an "empty leg" flight marketplace, generating $1.3M+ revenue and nearly 78,000 users in year one.
- Shipped Volato Mobile (11,000 users in six months) and the Volato Crew App for pilot scheduling (20 pilots in beta).
- Launched Volato AI, a GPT-4o sales agent inside the sales team's tools; kept customer-facing and internal systems at near-100% uptime.

Agrify, Inc. — Director of Software Engineering Remote (Burlington, MA) · 2018 – 2022

- Led a team of four engineers plus contractors building the Java IoT controllers that run Agrify's indoor farming units, maintaining 100% unit uptime.
- Helped build Agrify Insights, award-winning farm-operations software that reached 90% facility utilization, cut operating costs 30%, and ingests 1.5M+ data points per customer per year.

MoreBetter, Ltd. (Releaf) — Co-founder Washington, DC · 2015 – Present (part-time)

- Built Releaf, the top-rated cannabis journal on the App Store (4.7), to 100,000+ users and nearly 900,000 journal entries. Named inventor on US patent 11,253,195 B2; co-authored 15 published studies with the University of New Mexico and others.

Automata Studios — Co-founder, CEO & Software Engineer Washington, DC · 2006 – 2019

- Built a software and hardware studio that earned $10M+ over 12 years for IBM Watson, Frank Gehry, Victoria's Secret, Barnes & Noble, Adobe, and MTV; architected the Kids' Reader on Barnes & Noble's NOOK.

WORK YOU CAN INSPECT

- Wheelhouse, agent-fleet template (public, Unlicense, comes with me): github.com/morebetterltd/wheelhouse
- How I build with agent fleets, a 12-minute written tour of the setup, the controls, and a seven-stage path any engineer can follow: claude.ai/artifact/Ut67onpaXX98VadmYvfEEe
- Neo, code-reasoning engine with persistent semantic memory, co-built: github.com/Parslee-ai/neo
- A live walk-through of the fleets at work, on request

SKILLS

AI engineering: agent fleets, Claude Code, Model Context Protocol, LLM integration, policy-gated agent runtimes

Languages and data: C#/.NET, Java, TypeScript/Node.js, Python/Django, Swift, PostgreSQL, SQL, Cosmos DB

Cloud: Azure, AWS, Microsoft 365/Graph · Front end and mobile: React/Next.js, React Native, iOS · CI/CD with test, lint, and supply-chain gates

EDUCATION

University of Maryland, College Park: BS, Computer Science